Delivery Metrics & Tech Debt

Track how quickly and safely you deliver, keep technical debt visible, and plan time to pay it down.

Manage Flow · Inspired by DORA's Four Key Metrics · Technical Debt Quadrant (Martin Fowler)

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM / SYSTEM: Checkout and Basket

DATE: 14 May

1 Four Key Delivery Metrics

TWO FOR SPEED · TWO FOR STABILITY · TRACK THE TREND

Deployment Frequency — SPEED

How often we release to production.

- 3 months ago: 2 a week
- Now: 3 a week
- Target: daily
- Measured from: deploy pipeline log

☑ Better ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Lead Time for Changes — SPEED

Time from code committed to running in production.

- 3 months ago: 12 days
- Now: 7 days
- Target: under 2 days
- Measured from: commit to live

☑ Better ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Change Failure Rate — STABILITY

% of releases that cause a failure needing a fix.

- 3 months ago: 18%
- Now: 12%
- Target: under 10%
- Measured from: incident tickets

☑ Better ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Recovery Time — STABILITY

Time to restore service after a failed release.

- 3 months ago: 6 hours
- Now: 4 hours
- Target: under 1 hour
- Measured from: incident tickets

☐ Better ☑ Same ☐ Worse

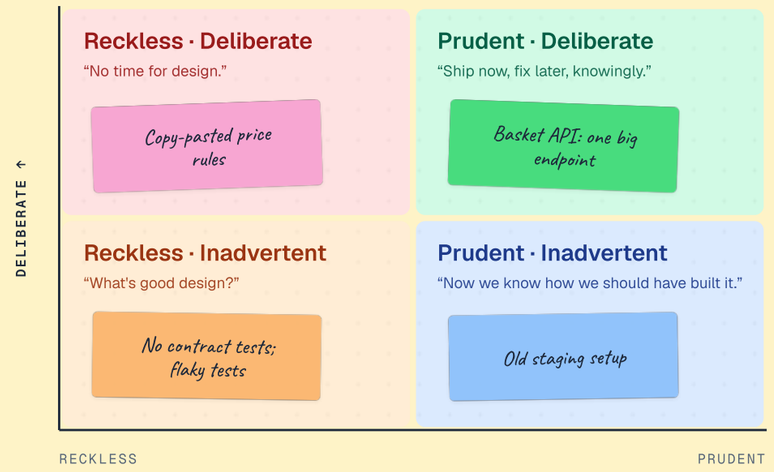
2 Tech Debt Register

THE INTEREST IS WHAT IT COSTS TO LEAVE IT

DEBT	WHERE	INTEREST: COST OF LEAVING IT	EFFORT S/M/L	TYPE	OWNER
Basket API: one big endpoint	Basket	every change touches it; 2 days extra a feature	L	prudent deliberate	Sam
No contract tests with Payments	Checkout	releases wait for manual sign-off	M	reckless inadvertent	Alex
Copy-pasted price rules	Basket	bugs fixed twice; promo errors	S	reckless deliberate	Jo
Old staging setup	Platform	staging goes down; blocked days	M	prudent inadvertent	Platform
Flaky reorder tests	Basket	reruns waste 30 minutes a day	S	reckless inadvertent	Ravi

3 Debt Quadrant

WHY THE DEBT EXISTS



4 Time to Pay It Down

- % of each iteration for debt & enablers: 20% (from the capacity split)
- This iteration we'll pay down: contract tests with Payments, flaky reorder tests

5 Review

LEARN, DON'T COMPARE TEAMS

- Metrics reviewed every: month, at the service delivery review
- What the trends tell us: faster and more stable since self-service deploys

"Are we getting faster without getting less stable?"

"Which debt is costing us most every week we leave it?"

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